

Train Your Mind To Stay Calm In Any Situation

Vocabulary and Grammar Handout

Intermediate Level

THE TEXT (Corrected Version)

Note: Only grammar and spelling errors have been corrected. Corrections are shown in bold.

“You’re making rapid progress!” I overheard a conversation on the way to school. “Keep up the good work! I believe that you can make it.” A young woman with long brown hair was chatting with a first-**grade** student. She is one of the English **teachers** in my school — Jenny. As soon as I realized she was really gorgeous in her beautiful blouse, **and** she revealed a charming smile to the little girl, I suddenly understood that they were practicing for the public English speaking **competition**. “Make it?” The girl replied with an innocent smile — “It means that I will get a good score and **win** the competition, right?”

Instantly, time **stood** still; memories **flooded** back.....

Five years ago, I decided to **enter** a speaking competition to challenge myself, and Jenny was the novice teacher **who taught** me speaking..... First, she taught me how to tug at the heartstrings with **my** voice. Maybe because it was the first time **she was teaching** one-on-one, I could tell she was a bit **nervous** when she tutored me. However, she always released her tension **through** her leisurely breathing, and practiced again and again with me with no **panting** or complaining. I no longer **felt** enthusiasm; countless **practices made** me **start** to doubt **whether** I **had taken** the wrong road, **and** whether to give up or not.

Shouldn’t I have not embarked on this difficult path that was surrounded by **frustration** and hurdles in the first place?..... I felt like **I was getting** lost in the vast ocean, until

she said a sentence that **moved my mind from helpless** to hopeful: “I believe that you **can** make it! **You haven’t** given up until today, right?”

Her words stayed with me; **they reminded** me that my heart was hesitating. Yeah!
Keep going!

“You are the best student **that** I have **ever** seen before.”.....

Heart pounding, **on** the day of the competition, I walked **onto** the stage with a grateful smile.

I **had** already given up on myself; I **blamed** myself **for not** making the correct decision back then, but an ordinary teacher always **gave** me positive energy and hope from **beginning to end**, **with** unconditional support for me even **when** I never **believed in** myself —

A soft **breath** took me from memories **back** to reality. “Keep going!” I shouted in my mind, **cheering** for my past **and** my future!

THE TEXT (Improved Version)

A polished version with clearer expression and natural flow.

“You’re making rapid progress! Keep up the good work — I believe you can make it!” The voice drifted toward me as I walked to school. A young woman with long brown hair was chatting cheerfully with a first-grade girl. She was Jenny, one of the English teachers at my school. The moment I noticed how lovely she looked in her elegant blouse, she flashed a warm smile at the little girl, and I suddenly realized they were rehearsing for the public English speaking competition. “Make it?” the girl asked with an innocent smile. “It means I’ll get a great score and win the competition, right?”

In that instant, time froze, and memories came flooding back.....

Five years ago, I decided to enter a speaking competition to challenge myself, and Jenny — then a novice teacher — was the one who guided me. First, she showed me how to move an audience with my voice. Perhaps because it was her very first time tutoring one-on-one, I could sense a hint of nervousness in her. Yet she always eased her tension with slow, steady breathing, and rehearsed with me over and over without ever sighing or complaining. Still, my enthusiasm began to fade. Endless practice made me wonder whether I had chosen the wrong path, and whether I should give up.

Shouldn’t I have avoided this difficult road, lined with frustration and hurdles, in the first place?..... I felt as if I were drifting, lost, in a vast ocean — until she spoke one sentence that lifted my heart from helpless to hopeful: “I believe you can make it! You haven’t given up so far, have you?”

Her words stayed with me, gently reminding me that my hesitation was holding me back. Yes — keep going!

“You’re the best student I’ve ever taught.”.....

With my heart pounding, I stepped onto the stage on the day of the competition, wearing a grateful smile.

I had nearly given up on myself, and I had even blamed myself for the decision I made back then. But this ordinary teacher had given me positive energy and hope from beginning to end — offering unconditional support even when I had stopped believing in myself.

A soft breath pulled me from memory back to the present. “Keep going!” I cheered silently in my mind — for the past version of me, and for the one yet to come.

PART A: VOCABULARY (12 Words)

Study the following vocabulary words from the text. Pay attention to how each word is used in context.

#	Word	Definition & Example from Text
1	overhear (v.)	to hear something by chance, especially a conversation “ <i>I overheard a conversation on the way to school.</i> ”
2	gorgeous (adj.)	beautiful; very attractive “ <i>I realized she was really gorgeous in her beautiful blouse.</i> ”
3	reveal (v.)	to show something that was previously hidden “ <i>She revealed a charming smile to the little girl.</i> ”
4	rehearse (v.)	to practice something in preparation for a performance “ <i>They were rehearsing for the public English speaking competition.</i> ”
5	novice (n./adj.)	a person new to or inexperienced in a skill or activity “ <i>Jenny was the novice teacher who taught me speaking.</i> ”
6	tutor (v.)	to teach a single student or a small group privately “ <i>She was a bit nervous when she tutored me.</i> ”
7	tension (n.)	mental or emotional strain “ <i>She always released her tension through her leisurely breathing.</i> ”
8	doubt (v.)	to feel uncertain about something “ <i>Countless practices made me start to doubt my path.</i> ”
9	frustration (n.)	the feeling of being upset because you cannot achieve something “ <i>This difficult path was surrounded by frustration and hurdles.</i> ”
10	hesitate (v.)	to pause before doing or saying something due to uncertainty “ <i>Her words reminded me that my heart was hesitating.</i> ”
11	grateful (adj.)	feeling or showing thanks “ <i>I walked onto the stage with a grateful smile.</i> ”
12	unconditional (adj.)	not limited by any conditions; complete and absolute “ <i>She gave me unconditional support even when I never believed in myself.</i> ”

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best word to complete each sentence.

1. I _____ my parents talking about the surprise party last night.
 - a) overheard
 - b) revealed
 - c) rehearsed
 - d) doubted

2. The actors _____ for the school play every afternoon this week.
 - a) tutor
 - b) rehearse
 - c) overhear
 - d) hesitate

3. She finally _____ her secret to her best friend.
 - a) doubted
 - b) tutored
 - c) revealed
 - d) overheard

4. Take a deep breath to release the _____ in your shoulders.
 - a) frustration
 - b) tension
 - c) novice
 - d) hesitation

5. I'm a complete _____ at chess; I just learned the rules yesterday.

- a) novice
- b) tension
- c) tutor
- d) doubt

6. My aunt _____ me in math twice a week before the exam.

- a) rehearsed
- b) overheard
- c) revealed
- d) tutored

7. A mother's love is often described as _____ and pure.

- a) grateful
- b) gorgeous
- c) unconditional
- d) novice

8. She felt deep _____ when she could not solve the puzzle.

- a) frustration
- b) tension
- c) hesitation
- d) tutor

9. Don't _____ to call me if you need any help.

- a) rehearse
- b) reveal
- c) overhear
- d) hesitate

10. The sunset over the ocean was absolutely _____.

- a) gorgeous
- b) novice
- c) unconditional
- d) grateful

11. I am so _____ for all the support my friends gave me.

- a) novice
- b) gorgeous
- c) grateful
- d) hesitant

12. The detective began to _____ the witness's story after finding new evidence.

- a) tutor
- b) doubt
- c) rehearse
- d) reveal

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blanks

Complete each sentence with the correct word from the box. (Words may be used in different forms; some may be used more than once.)

**overhear · reveal · rehearse · tutor · tension · frustration ·
unconditional · novice**

1. The dancers will _____ the routine one more time before the show.
2. She didn't mean to _____ their conversation, but they were speaking too loudly.
3. The magician will not _____ the secret behind his trick.
4. There is a lot of _____ between the two teams before the final match.
5. My older brother used to _____ me in English when I was little.
6. After hours of trying to fix the printer, his _____ finally exploded.
7. Although he is a _____ in cooking, his pasta tastes amazing.
8. A good parent gives their child _____ love.
9. I _____ed my speech in front of the mirror until I was confident.
10. The investigator promised to _____ the truth at the press conference.
11. You can feel the _____ in the classroom right before a big test.
12. Even as a _____, she finished the marathon without stopping.

PART B: GRAMMAR (4 Patterns)

Study the following grammar structures from the text.

Pattern 1: “As soon as + clause”

Form: As soon as + subject + verb, subject + verb

Use: To express that one action happens immediately after another.

Example from text: *“As soon as I realized she was gorgeous, she revealed a charming smile.”*

More examples:

- As soon as the bell rang, the students rushed out of the classroom.
- As soon as I got home, I took off my shoes.
- As soon as she heard the news, she called her mother.

Pattern 2: “no longer + verb”

Form: Subject + no longer + verb (or Subject + auxiliary + no longer + verb)

Use: To express that something that was once true is no longer true.

Example from text: *“I no longer felt enthusiasm.”*

More examples:

- He no longer lives in Taipei.
- She no longer enjoys spicy food.
- They are no longer friends.

Pattern 3: “feel like + clause / -ing”

Form: Subject + feel like + clause / -ing form

Use: To describe a sensation, feeling, or imagined experience.

Example from text: *“I felt like I was getting lost in the vast ocean.”*

More examples:

- I feel like I am dreaming.
- She felt like crying after the movie ended.
- He feels like he can fly when he listens to that song.

Pattern 4: “from ... to ...”

Form: from + noun/adjective + to + noun/adjective

Use: To describe a change, shift, or movement between two states or points.

Example from text: *“She moved my mind from helpless to hopeful.”*

More examples:

- His mood changed from happy to sad in just one minute.
- The shop is open from Monday to Saturday.
- The temperature dropped from warm to freezing overnight.

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best option to complete each sentence.

1. _____ I opened the door, the cat ran outside.
 - a) As soon as
 - b) No longer
 - c) From
 - d) Feel like

2. After the accident, he _____ drives at night.
 - a) as soon as
 - b) feels like
 - c) no longer
 - d) from

3. I _____ I have known her for years, but we just met.
 - a) feel like
 - b) no longer
 - c) as soon as
 - d) from

4. The class will run _____ 9 a.m. _____ 12 p.m.
 - a) as soon as / from
 - b) from / to
 - c) no longer / feel
 - d) feel / like

5. She started running _____ she heard the alarm.
 - a) no longer

- b) from
- c) to
- d) as soon as

6. My grandmother _____ remembers what she ate yesterday.

- a) no longer
- b) as soon as
- c) feel like
- d) from

7. After the long hike, I _____ collapsing on the bed.

- a) felt like
- b) no longer
- c) as soon as
- d) from

8. His feelings shifted _____ excitement _____ disappointment.

- a) as soon as / from
- b) from / to
- c) no longer / feel
- d) feel / like

9. _____ the movie ended, everyone started clapping.

- a) No longer
- b) From
- c) As soon as
- d) Feel like

10. Since the surgery, my father _____ plays tennis.

- a) feels like
- b) as soon as
- c) from
- d) no longer

11. When I saw the old photo, I _____ I was a child again.

- a) felt like
- b) no longer
- c) as soon as
- d) from

12. Her grades improved _____ a C _____ an A in just one semester.

- a) as soon as / from
- b) no longer / feel
- c) from / to
- d) feel / like

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation

Follow each instruction to rewrite or combine the sentences.

1. Combine using “as soon as”:

I finished my homework. I went to bed.

2. Rewrite using “no longer”:

She doesn't play the piano anymore.

3. Rewrite using “feel like”:

My legs are so tired that they seem to be made of stone.

4. Combine using “from ... to ...”:

The meeting starts at 2 p.m. The meeting ends at 4 p.m.

5. Combine using “as soon as”:

The rain stopped. The children went outside.

6. Rewrite using “no longer”:

He doesn't work at the bank now.

7. Combine using “as soon as”:

My mom got the message. She called me back.

8. Rewrite using “no longer”:

They are not friends anymore.

9. Rewrite using “feel like”:

I really want to eat ice cream right now.

10. Combine using “from ... to ...”:

The temperature dropped from a hot 35 degrees. It became a chilly 10 degrees.

11. Rewrite using “feel like”:

She wanted to cry after hearing the bad news.

12. Combine using “from ... to ...”:

His mood was happy in the morning. It became sad in the evening.

ANSWER KEY

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. a) overheard 2. b) rehearse 3. c) revealed 4. b) tension 5. a) novice 6. d) tutored 7. c) unconditional 8. a) frustration 9. d) hesitate 10. a) gorgeous 11. c) grateful 12. b) doubt

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blanks (Sample Answers)

1. rehearse 2. overhear 3. reveal 4. tension 5. tutor 6. frustration 7. novice 8. unconditional 9. rehearse 10. reveal 11. tension 12. novice

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. a) As soon as 2. c) no longer 3. a) feel like 4. b) from / to 5. d) as soon as 6. a) no longer 7. a) felt like 8. b) from / to 9. c) As soon as 10. d) no longer 11. a) felt like 12. c) from / to

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation (Sample Answers)

1. As soon as I finished my homework, I went to bed.
2. She no longer plays the piano.
3. My legs feel like they are made of stone.
4. The meeting runs from 2 p.m. to 4 p.m.
5. As soon as the rain stopped, the children went outside.
6. He no longer works at the bank.
7. As soon as my mom got the message, she called me back.
8. They are no longer friends.
9. I feel like eating ice cream right now.
10. The temperature dropped from 35 degrees to 10 degrees.
11. She felt like crying after hearing the bad news.
12. His mood changed from happy to sad.